

Answer-1

Publishing and sharing reports are more important than just building dashboards in Power BI Desktop because Power BI Desktop is only a development tool, while the actual consumption, collaboration, and decision-making happen in the Power BI Service.

When a report is published, it becomes accessible to stakeholders through the cloud, enabling:

- **Collaboration:** Teams can view, comment, and interact with the same report in real time.
- **Accessibility:** Reports can be accessed from anywhere- web, mobile, or apps—unlike Desktop which is limited to the creator's machine.
- **Data Refresh & Automation:** Scheduled refresh, gateways, and version control work only after publishing.
- **Governance & Security:** Features like RLS, workspace roles, and app distribution ensure secure and controlled sharing.
- **Scalability:** One published report can serve hundreds of users without sending multiple files.

So, publishing transforms a dashboard from a local file into an enterprise-ready, shareable, secure, and interactive analytics solution

Answer-2

Power BI Desktop is used for **data modeling, cleaning, and report creation**.

Power BI Service is used for **sharing, collaboration, automation, and secure distribution** of those reports.

Answer-3

Publishing a report in Power BI means uploading the report created in **Power BI Desktop** to the **Power BI Service (cloud platform)**. This makes the report accessible to others through the web, mobile app, or workspace, enabling collaboration and secure sharing.

Two outcomes after publishing a report:

1. **The report becomes available in a Power BI workspace**
. Users with access can view, interact, and analyze the report online.
2. **A dataset is automatically created in the Power BI Service**

. This dataset can be used for scheduled refresh, building new reports, or applying security (RLS)

Answer-4

1. Save the report in Power BI Desktop

Before publishing, the report must be saved as a .pbix file on your system.

2. Click the “Publish” button in Power BI Desktop

Located on the Home ribbon — this starts the upload process.

3. Sign in to your Power BI account

If not already signed in, Power BI prompts you to authenticate using your organizational or personal account.

4. Select a destination workspace

You choose where the report will be published — My Workspace or any shared workspace you have access to.

5. Upload completes and confirmation appears

Power BI Desktop shows a success message confirming the report is now available in the Service.

6. Open the report in Power BI Service

A link appears that takes you directly to the published report online, where you can view, share, and manage it.

Answer-5

A report is a multi-page, detailed analytical document created in Power BI Desktop with full interactivity.

A dashboard is a single-page, high-level view created only in Power BI Service using pinned visuals. Reports allow deep exploration, while dashboards are used for quick monitoring and decision-making.

Answer-6

1. Direct Report Sharing

You share a specific report or dashboard directly with selected users by entering their email IDs. They get access only to that single item — not the entire workspace.

Use Case

A manager wants to share one sales report with two team members for quick review.

2. Workspace Access

You add users to a workspace with specific roles (Viewer, Contributor, Member, Admin). They get access to all reports, datasets, and dashboards inside that workspace.

Use Case

A data analytics team works together in a workspace to build and update multiple reports.

3. Power BI Apps

A packaged, read-only version of reports and dashboards published from a workspace. Users consume the content without accessing the underlying workspace.

Use Case

An organization publishes a Finance App containing all finance dashboards for 500+ employees.

Answer-7

1. Viewer

What they can do

- View reports, dashboards, and datasets
- Interact with visuals (filters, slicers, drill-down)
- Cannot edit or publish anything

Purpose

Ideal for end-users who only need to consume reports.

2. Contributor

What they can do

- Create and edit reports in the workspace
- Publish new reports from Power BI Desktop
- Refresh datasets manually
- Cannot manage workspace settings or permissions

Purpose

Used by analysts who build or update reports but don't manage governance.

3. Member

What they can do

- All Contributor permissions
- Update and publish Power BI Apps
- Manage datasets (refresh, schedule, parameters)
- Delete content inside the workspace

Purpose

Suitable for senior analysts or team leaders who manage content lifecycle.

4. Admin

What they can do

- Full control over the workspace
- Add/remove users and assign roles
- Change workspace settings
- Publish/update apps
- Delete the workspace

Purpose

Reserved for workspace owners or administrators responsible for governance.

Power BI uses role-based access control (RBAC) to ensure that each user only gets the level of access they need:

- Admins assign roles to users based on responsibility
- Lower roles (Viewer) ensure secure consumption without editing
- Higher roles (Member, Admin) ensure controlled collaboration
- This prevents unauthorized edits, accidental deletions, and data misuse
- Ensures governance, security, and proper content management across teams

Answer-8

Power BI Apps are designed for large-scale, secure, and governed distribution of analytics across an organization. Compared to direct sharing, Apps provide better control, consistency, and security — making them ideal for enterprise environments.

1. Centralized, Controlled Distribution

Power BI Apps

- All reports, dashboards, and datasets are packaged into one managed bundle.
- Users receive a read-only, stable version of the content.
- Updates can be pushed in a controlled manner without affecting users' access.

Why is this more secure

- No accidental edits
- No version confusion
- No uncontrolled sharing

2. Role-Based Access & Governance

Power BI Apps

- Access is controlled at the workspace level, not per-report.
- Only Members/Admins can update the App; end-users can only view it.
- Ensures strict separation between content creators and content consumers.

Why is this more secure

- Prevents unauthorized changes
- Ensuring governance policies are followed
- Reduces risk of data exposure

3. Scalable for Hundreds or Thousands of Users

Power BI Apps

- Designed for enterprise-wide rollout.
- One App can be assigned to large groups, departments, or the entire company.

- No need to share each report individually.

Why this is more scalable

- Easy onboarding
- Consistent experience for all users
- No performance or management issues from excessive direct sharing

4. Better Security Controls

Power BI Apps

- Support advanced governance features like
 - Row-Level Security (RLS)
 - Workspace roles
 - Centralized dataset management
- Users cannot reshare content unless explicitly allowed.

Why is this more secure

- Sensitive data stays protected
- Only authorized users see the right data
- Reduces risk of data leaks

5. Professional, Organized User Experience

Power BI Apps

- Provide a clean, structured interface with grouped reports.
- Users always access the latest, approved version.

Why these matters

- Avoids confusion
- Ensure consistency across teams
- Supports enterprise reporting standards

Answer-9

Row-Level Security (RLS) is a Power BI feature that restricts data at the row level based on the user who is viewing the report. It ensures that each user only sees the data they are authorized to see — even though the same report and same dataset is used for everyone.

RLS is implemented using:

- Roles (e.g., Sales Manager, Regional Manager)
- DAX filters (e.g., [Region] = "North")

How RLS Ensures Different Users See Different Data using same report:

Even though all users open **the same report**, RLS applies different filters for each user. This means:

- A **North Region Manager** sees only North region data
- A **South Region Manager** sees only South region data
- A **CEO** (no RLS restriction) sees all data

The report layout, visuals, and pages remain the same — only the **underlying data changes** based on the user's identity.

Answer-10

When an organization shares reports without **Power BI Apps, workspace roles, or Row-Level Security (RLS)**, several risks arise that can lead to data leaks, unauthorized access, and governance failures.

Below are **three major risks** and how Power BI best practices prevent them.

1. Unauthorized Access to Sensitive Data

Issue

If reports are shared directly (e.g., via links or file downloads), users may access data they are **not supposed to see**, such as salaries, regional sales, or confidential KPIs.

How Best Practices Prevent This

- **RLS** ensures each user sees only the data relevant to them.
- **Workspace roles** restrict who can view, edit, or publish content.

- **Apps** provide read-only, controlled access to approved reports.

2. Accidental Editing, Deletion, or Modification of Reports

Issue

Without workspace roles or Apps, users may receive edit access unintentionally. This can lead to:

- Broken visuals
- Deleted pages
- Incorrect filters
- Damaged datasets

How Best Practices Prevent This

- **Viewer role** ensures users can only view, not edit.
- **Apps** provide a **read-only** experience for all consumers.
- **Member/Admin roles** ensure only authorized creators can modify content.

3. Lack of Governance and Version Control

Issue

Sharing reports informally (email, exports, screenshots) leads to:

- Multiple versions of the same report
- No audit trail
- No control over who reshares the data
- Outdated or inconsistent insights across teams

How Best Practices Prevent This

- **Apps** provide a single, centralized, always-updated version.
- **Workspaces** maintain proper ownership, permissions, and content lifecycle.
- **RLS + workspace roles** ensure secure, governed distribution.

